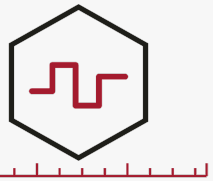
Your awesome title

A subtitle

Your name



Harvard John A. Paulson
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HARVARD UNIVERSITY
MaDSys
Measurement and Design of Systems Lab

Content

- Please use illustrations
- **Background**: what the audience needs to know
- **Motivation**: where today's systems fall short
- **Design**: the overview, the key component, a walk-through
- **Evaluation**: the headline result, and why it holds

Background: necessary knowledge

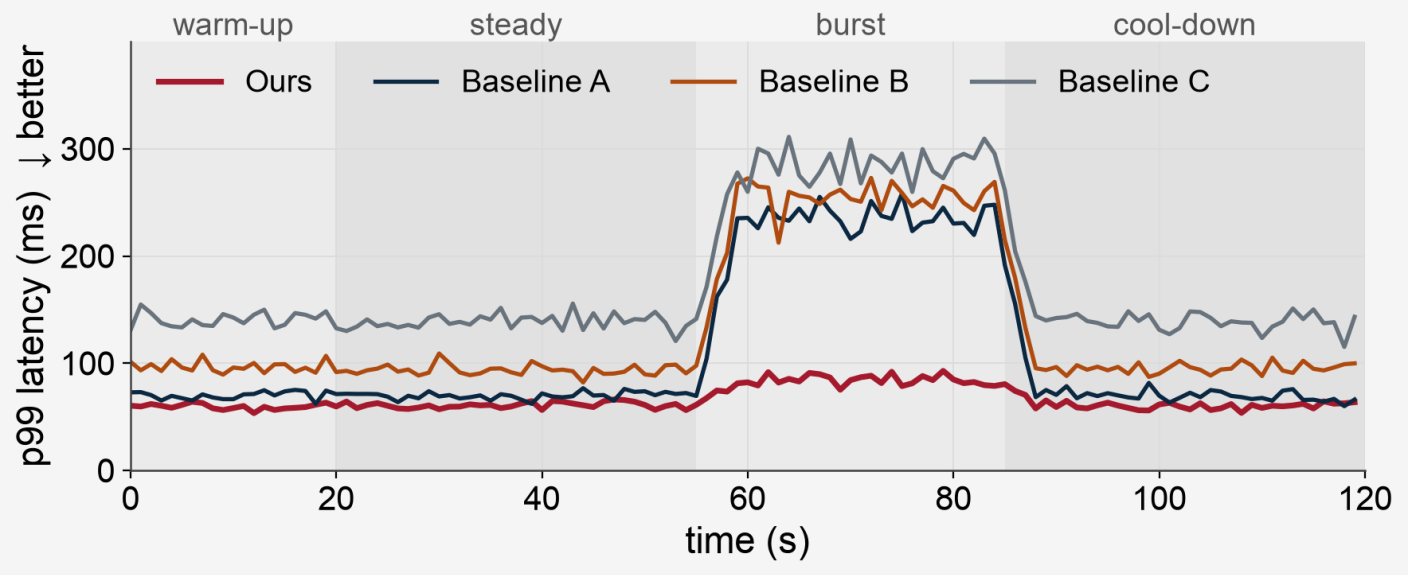
- Please use illustrations
- Assume the audience is an undergraduate in computer science
- Tell people anything they need to know about this talk

> **Definition (Tail latency).** The 99th-percentile request latency (p99): one request in a hundred is slower.

Motivation: gap

- Provide today's landscape (state-of-the-art)
  - What people have done
  - Where they fall short
  - Why they do not work
- Show numbers and figures

Today's systems fall over under bursts



- **Bursts** triple the p99 latency of every baseline[1]
- **Ours** stays within 1.4× of its steady-state p99[2]

[1] Burst: 55–88 s, at 1.8× the steady-state request rate.

[2] Footnotes sit at the bottom of the slide, numbered in the order of the marks.

Design

Overview, key component, and a walk-through

Design 1

- Give an overview
- Different components in the system
- How they interact with each other
  - Highlight the one term the audience must keep in mind

Design 2

- Focus on the key component
- Use illustrations with animation
  - Marp has no animations: build the figure up over consecutive slides

Design 3

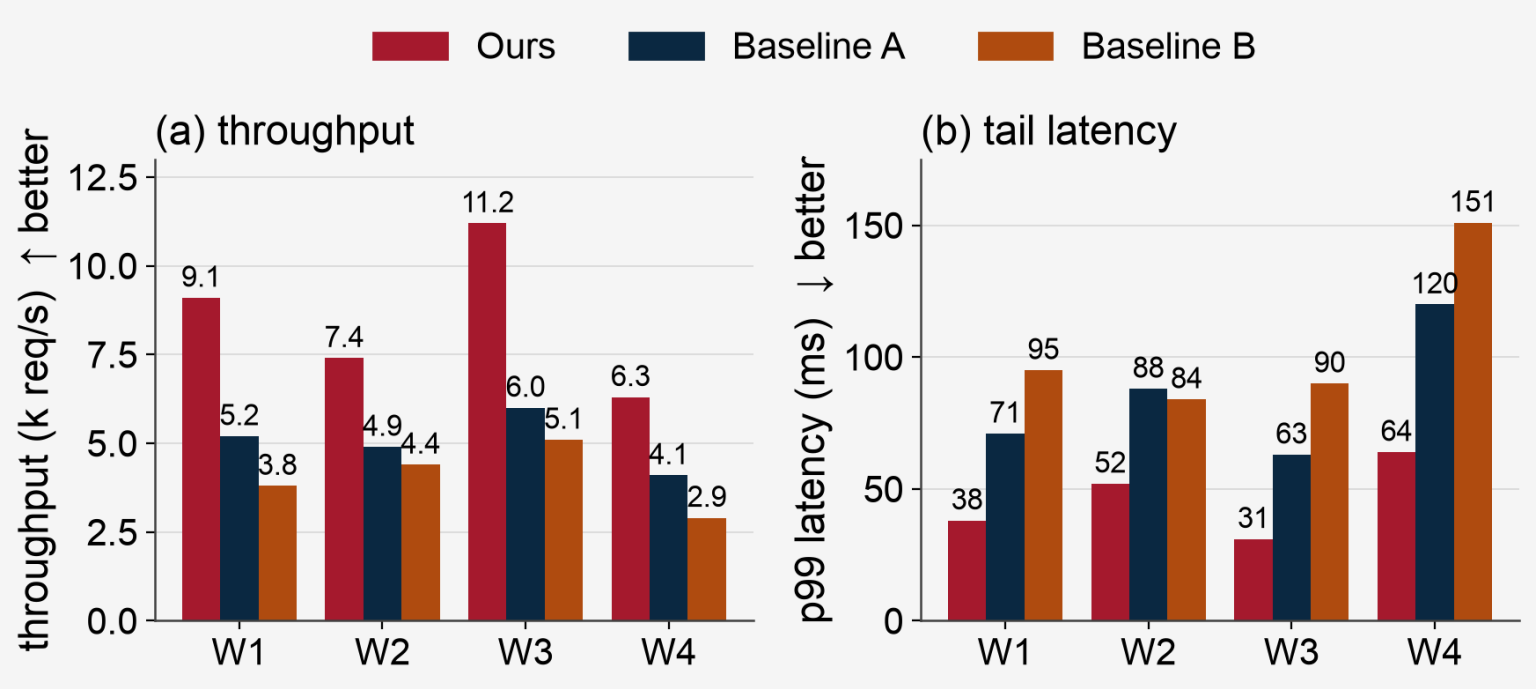
- Walk through a request / an example
  1. The client sends a request
  2. The scheduler places it on a worker
  3. The worker replies; the scheduler records the latency

Evaluation

- Your system / algorithm beats the state-of-the-art on metric X
- Focus on high-level results and only show one or two figures
- Explain the figures in detail
  - Tell the audience what X and Y are, which direction is better, and how to read the figures
  - Show one system at a time
  - Explain the results

F1 · Ours doubles throughput A

1.5–1.9× the throughput of Baseline A, at 0.5–0.6× its p99 latency.



(a) Throughput, higher is better. (b) p99 latency, lower is better. Made-up example data.

Details · F1

workload	Ours (k req/s)	Baseline A	Baseline B	speed-up vs A
W1	9.1	5.2	3.8	1.75×
W2	7.4	4.9	4.4	1.51×
W3	11.2	6.0	5.1	1.87×
W4	6.3	4.1	2.9	1.54×

workload	Ours p99	Baseline A p99	Baseline B p99
W1	38 ms	71 ms	95 ms
W4	64 ms	120 ms	151 ms

- Detail slides hold the numbers behind the previous figure; skip them when presenting.
- Text columns are left-aligned (`---`), numeric columns right-aligned (`---:`).

Evaluation 2

- Show why your system works ← this is the insight people look for
- Do not add more figures beyond this for talk < 20 min

> **Finding (F2).** Most of the gain comes from the key component: without it, the p99 under bursts is within 10% of Baseline A.

More in the paper

- Tell people what else you have done that they might be interested in
- Provide a link and QR code to the paper
- madsys.seas.harvard.edu



Summary and takeaway

1. **Use short bullet points:** one claim and its number. A
2. **Second takeaway:** the supporting number. B C
3. **Add your name and contact:** Your Name · you@seas.harvard.edu

? Questions?

Definitions, findings, questions

Definition (Period). A stretch of data collected under one configuration.

Finding (F1). Ours doubles throughput on all four workloads.

Finding. With blank lines inside the tags, the body takes **Markdown**, lists included:

- a finding without a title is labelled *Finding*.
- a definition without a title is labelled *Definition*.

? Should this case count towards workload W1 or W2?

Details · Notes for the speaker only

- The `personal-use` class adds the red badge at the top right: a slide not meant for the audience.
- Combine it with `details` as `<!-- _class: details personal-use -->`.
- Inline code renders like `uv run make_figures.py`.